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Portable multi-function air conditioner with a lid-based fluid pump

Abstract

A portable multi-function air conditioner comprises a fluid pump disposed in a lid associated with an insulated reservoir configured to hold a liquid and ice, a heat exchanger configured to cool air flowing through the heat exchanger. A fan may be configured to move air across the heat exchanger and discharge the air through an outlet port associated with one of the reservoir or the lid. A power connection may be carried on the lid and may provide power to the at least one pump.

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Background/Summary

PRIORITY (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/882,511, filed Sep. 11, 2024, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/778,374, filed Jul. 19, 2024, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,130,065, which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/457,047, filed Aug. 28, 2023, now U.S. Pat. No. 12,061,037, which claims the benefit of the filing date and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/518,039, filed Aug. 7, 2023, each of which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

FIELD

(1) The present disclosure is directed to air conditioning and, more particularly, to systems and methods relating to portable multi-function air conditioners.

BACKGROUND

(2) Weather experienced in various climates and environments can reduce the enjoyment of certain activities and poses various dangers. High humidity and low humidity affect the body's ability to regulate temperature. For example, high humidity may cause excess perspiration, while low humidity may cause perspiration to dry quickly, both leading to dehydration. When high humidity or low humidity are coupled with hot weather or cold weather, overheating and hypothermia can occur. These dangers are most common when outside or in buildings that do not have air conditioning systems and/or heaters. Accordingly, there is a need to provide portable multi-function air conditioner in all environments.

SUMMARY

(3) Consistent with some examples, a portable multi-function air conditioner comprises an insulated reservoir configured to hold a liquid and ice, a lid associated with the reservoir to provide selective access to the reservoir, a heat exchanger, at least one pump configured to move a first portion of the liquid through the heat exchanger as a first function and discharge a second portion of the liquid through a spray nozzle as a second function, a fan configured to move air across the heat exchanger, and discharge the air through an outlet port associated with one of the reservoir or the lid, the discharged air intermingling with the discharged second portion of the liquid to condition the air, and a power supply operatively coupled with and providing power to the at least one pump and the fan.

(4) Consistent with some examples, a method for conditioning air using a portable, multi-function air conditioner having a reservoir and a lid that provides access to the reservoir comprises

selectively performing a first conditioning function by moving a first portion of a liquid held in the reservoir through a heat exchanger using at least one pump, moving air across a heat exchanger using a fan, and discharging the conditioned air through an outlet port in the multi-function air conditioner using the fan. The method may further comprise selectively performing a second conditioning function by discharging a second portion of the liquid into the conditioned air from the multi-function air conditioner through a spray nozzle using the at least one pump.

(5) Consistent with some examples, a multi-function air conditioner having a reservoir for holding a liquid and having a lid providing access to the reservoir is configured to condition air using a first portion of the liquid, discharge the conditioned air through the outlet port as a first function, and discharge a second portion of the liquid through a nozzle into the conditioned air as a second function.

(6) Other examples include corresponding methods, computer systems, apparatus, and computer programs recorded on one or more computer storage devices, each configured to perform the actions described herein.

(7) It is to be understood that both the foregoing general description and the following detailed description are exemplary and explanatory in nature and are intended to provide an understanding of the present disclosure without limiting the scope of the present disclosure. In that regard, additional aspects, features, and advantages of the present disclosure will be apparent to one skilled in the art from the following detailed description.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a portable multi-function, ice-based air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(2) FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view of a chest of a portable multi-function air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(3) FIG. 3 is an exploded perspective view of a lid of a portable multi-function air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(4) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(5) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(6) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(7) FIG. 7 is an illustrative method relating to conditioning air in all environments using a portable multi-function air conditioner, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure.

(8) Examples of the present disclosure and their advantages are best understood by referring to the detailed description that follows. It should be appreciated that like reference numerals are used to identify like elements illustrated in one or more of the figures, wherein showings therein are for purposes of illustrating examples of the present disclosure and not for purposes of limiting the same.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(9) Accordingly, the present disclosure contemplates system and methods for portable multi-function air conditioning in all environments.

(10) For the purpose of promoting an understanding of the principles of the present disclosure, reference will now be made to the implementations illustrated in the drawings and specific language will be used to describe them. It will nevertheless be understood that no limitation of the scope of the disclosure is intended. Any alterations and further modifications to the described

devices, instruments, methods, and any further application of the principles of the present disclosure are fully contemplated as would normally occur to one skilled in the art to which the disclosure relates. In addition, this disclosure describes some elements or features in detail with respect to one or more implementations or figures, when those same elements or features appear in subsequent figures, without such a high level of detail.

(11) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a portable multi-function air conditioner **100** usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** includes a chest **101** having a body **102** and a lid **104**. The lid **104** may be hingedly connected to the body **102** to provide selective access to a reservoir **102** (shown in FIG. 2). The lid **104** may be connected in other ways, for example, the lid **104** may slide onto the body **102**, or the body **102** have a clamshell opening, among other configurations. The body **102** and the lid **104** may comprise molded plastic or other suitable materials. The chest **101** can be configured to provide functions beneficial for coolers, ice chests, and other outdoor equipment. In one example, molded drink holders **106** may be defined in the lid **104**. In some examples, a drain **108** is accessible from outside the body **102** and configured to drain liquid from the chest **101**. The lid **104** may latch or lock to the body **102** to keep the contents within the chest **101** secured and cool.

(12) The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** may be movable by way of wheels **110** and/or a tow handle **112**. The wheels **110** and the tow handle **112** may be arranged differently than shown. There may be more or fewer of the wheels **110** and tow handles **112** than shown. In some examples, the tow handle **112** stows against the body **102** when not in use. The tow handle **112** may hinge outwardly to allow for lifting of a portion of the body **102**. Once a portion of the body **102** is lifted, pulling on the tow handle **112** will allow for movement of the wheels **110**. Additional handles may be included on the chest **101**. In some examples, a lid handle **114** may be coupled to the lid to allow a user to open and close the lid **104**. In some examples, lift handles **116** may be coupled to the body and allow a user to carry and transport the chest **101**.

(13) The chest **101** can be configured to hold liquid, air, and other objects such as ice, beverages, food, ice packs, etc. In some examples, the body **102** of the chest **101** has the reservoir **103** for holding the liquid, air, and/or other objects. The reservoir **103** may be defined by a liner separate from the body **102**. In some examples, the body **102** itself defines the reservoir **103**. The reservoir, like the body **102** and the lid **104**, may be molded plastic or another suitable material. In some examples, the body **102** is insulated with insulation (not shown) between all or portions of the body **102** and the reservoir **103**. The insulation may be foam or other suitable materials. In some examples, the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** may also function as a beverage cooler or ice chest, which may call for additional structure or organization of components within the reservoir **103**.

(14) In some examples, warm air is drawn into the reservoir **103** of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** through at least one inlet **118**. The at least one inlet **118** can be located at the conjunction of the lid **104** and the body **102**. Such a location may allow the at least one inlet **118** to be hidden from plain view and allows air to enter the chest **101** even when a substantial amount of ice, liquid, food, drinks, or other objects are located in the reservoir **103**. In some examples, the inlet **118** is placed on the front of the chest while another inlet **118** is placed on a side of the chest opposite the fan. Placing inlets away from and opposite a fan **304** (shown in FIG. 3) ensures that air flows across the cold objects within the reservoir **103**. As air moves across these cold objects, the temperature of the warm air begins to decrease, before continuing throughout the rest of the system.

(15) In some examples, the at least one inlet **118** may be configured to allow air to enter the chest **101** when suction force is applied by the system (e.g., when a fan is pulling air from within the chest **101**) but prevents air from exiting the chest **101** when the suction force subsides (e.g., when the fan is off). In this sense, the at least one inlet **118** may act as a one-way valve. The at least one inlet **118** of this nature ensure that cold air within the chest **101** does not escape, increasing the time

it takes for ice within the chest **101** to melt.

(16) The chest **101** may have an outlet port **120**, a flexible tube **122**, and a vent **124**, which facilitate the movement of cooled air and/or liquid out of the chest **101**. These features will be discussed in more detail below with respect to FIG. 3.

(17) FIG. 2 is a perspective view of the chest **101** of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. As shown, two hinges **214** can straddle the inside of the reservoir **103** and the outside of the body **102** and hingedly connect to the lid **104**. More or less than two of the hinges **214** can be used to attach the lid **104** to the chest **101**. Other forms of attachment are also possible, including the forms described above with respect to FIG. 1.

(18) In some examples, the body **102** may be molded to accept an axle **200** attached to the wheels **110**. The wheels **110** may be attached to the axle **200** by bushings **202**. The wheels **110** may be held in place by caps **204**. In some examples, the wheels **110** are detachable from the body **102**, rather than integrated as shown. In some examples, the drain **108** has a drain body **206** that traverses from inside the reservoir **103** to outside the body **102**. The drain body **206** may be retained in place by a gasket **208** and a nut **210**. A drain plug **212** may be provided for opening and closing the drain **108**.

(19) Liquid, air, and other objects can be held by the reservoir **103**. The reservoir **103** may hold ice, drinks, liquid (e.g., water), food, and other objects, depending on the circumstances. When the reservoir **103** is filled with ice, the insulative properties of the portable multi-function air conditioner can maintain the ice in a solid state for an extended period of time. The ice or other chilled objects within the reservoir **103** will cool the warm air drawn into the chest **101** as the air passes across it. The air can further be cooled by systems and methods described herein. It is understood that the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** can alternatively be filled with hot liquid or objects and be used during times of cold weather to discharge warm air and/or warm liquid.

(20) In some examples, a pump **216** is situated within the reservoir **103**. To ensure that all of the fluid can be pumped out of the reservoir **103**, it may be beneficial to place the pump **216** in a lower portion of the reservoir **103**. In some examples, the pump **216** is used to move liquid from within the reservoir **103** to the lid **104**. Particularly, the pump **216** may move the liquid from the reservoir **103** to a heat exchanger **218** (shown in FIG. 3). Additionally, the pump **216** may move liquid to a spray nozzle **220** (also shown in FIG. 3) to be discharged from the chest **101**. In some examples, to move liquid from the reservoir **103** to the heat exchanger **218** or the spray nozzle **220**, the pump moves the liquid through liquid conduit **222**. The liquid conduit **222** may branch into a heat exchanger intake conduit **224** and a spray nozzle conduit **226**. In some examples, there are more than one of the liquid conduit **222**, where one of the liquid conduit **222** acts separately as the heat exchanger intake conduit **224** and another of the liquid conduit **222** acts as the spray nozzle conduit. In such an example, one or more pumps may be used to move fluid through the heat exchanger intake conduit **224** and the spray nozzle conduit **226**. The use of more or fewer of the liquid conduit **222** may be beneficial to minimize pressure inconsistencies throughout the system. The pump **216** may be a 12-volt electrically powered impeller-based pump and may have a flow rate of around 3 liters per minute.

(21) In some examples, the pump **216** is protected and/or held in place by a cover **228**. The pump **216** may draw in cooled liquid through an opening **229** in the cover **228**. Both the pump **216** and the opening **229** may be near a lower portion of the cover **228** and be situated relatively low in the reservoir **103**. This allows the pump **216** continuous access to the cooled liquid in the reservoir **103** even if most of the liquid has already exited the chest **101**. The cover **228** may attach to the interior of the reservoir **103**, the pump **216** being situated inside the cover **228** when it is installed. The cover **228** provides protection for the liquid conduit **222** that attached to the pump **216** for moving liquid to the heat exchanger **218** and/or the spray nozzle **220**.

(22) In some examples, the cover also provides protection for a return conduit **230**. The return

conduit **230** may traverse all or a part of the length of the cover **228** before exiting. In some examples, a length of the return conduit **230** extends away from the cover **228** to return liquid some distance away from the pump **216**. The return conduit **230** may return liquid back to the reservoir **103** after it has passed through the heat exchanger **218**. This allows for a continuous heat exchanging system whereby the fins of the heat exchanger **218** are continually supplied with new cool liquid for transferring heat away from the warm air. It may be beneficial to return liquid away from the pump **216** so that the liquid can mix with the rest of the liquid in the reservoir **103** and drop in temperature before being sucked into the heat exchanger **218** again. In some examples, the liquid in the return conduit **230** may pass through another heat exchanger before being returned to the reservoir **103**, as explained further below with respect to FIG. **6**. In other examples, it may be desirable for the liquid that passes through the heat exchanger **218** to be interoperable with other functions of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**, such as the spray nozzle described herein.

(23) In some examples, the opening **229** is configured to filter and prevent debris present within the reservoir **103** from entering the liquid conduit **222**. Additionally, a separate filter (similar to the one shown below in FIG. **3**) may be used to filter the liquid prior to its entry into the heat exchanger **218** and/or the spray nozzle conduit **226**. The filter may be positioned along the liquid conduit **222** such that the liquid is filtered before splitting between the heat exchanger intake conduit **224** and the spray nozzle conduit **226**.

(24) From the foregoing, it will be appreciated that, particularly where the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** also serves as a beverage cooler or the like, the cover **228** safely stows and routes the pump **216**, the liquid conduit **222**, and the return conduit **230**, and/or other components (e.g., filters) and conduits.

(25) FIG. **3** is an exploded perspective view of the lid **104** of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** which is usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. The lid **104** may comprise an upper shell **300** fitted with a lower shell **302**. In some examples, the upper shell **300** and the lower shell **302** may comprise a molded plastic material and may fit together via fasteners, interference fit, electronic welding, or other means. A major function of the lid is to retain a significant number of components associated with the air cooling and/or heating function of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. Like the chest **101**, the lid **104** may include insulation (not shown) between all or portions of the upper shell **300** and the lower shell **302**. The insulation may be foam or other suitable materials.

(26) In some examples, the heat exchanger **218** may be attached to the lower shell **302** and/or the upper shell **300**. The heat exchanger **218** may be made from aluminum or another material with good thermal conductive properties. The pump **216** described above with respect to FIG. **2** can move cool liquid (e.g., water) from the reservoir **103** through the liquid conduit **222**, through the heat exchanger intake conduit **224**, and into and through the heat exchanger **218**. The cool liquid can cool fins of the heat exchanger **218**, the cooled fins allowing for heat transfer to occur between the heat exchanger **218** and air passing across it. In some examples, an exchanger cover **306** may protect and surround the heat exchanger **218** to filter the air and prevent clogging and/or buildup on the heat exchanger **218** as air travels across it. After the cool liquid passes through the heat exchanger **218** it may return to the reservoir **103** by way of the return conduit **230**.

(27) In some examples, the fan **304** is housed between the upper shell **300** and the lower shell **302**. The fan **304** may be an electronic fan. The fan **304** may be positioned in close proximity to the heat exchanger **218**, so that the fan can draw/push air from within the reservoir **103** across the heat exchanger **218**. As air passes across the heat exchanger **218**, the air will lose heat to the fins, due to the temperature difference between the heat exchanger **218** and the air. In some examples (e.g., cold weather), where warm liquid is used to condition the air, the heat exchanger **218** containing warm liquid will lose heat to the air so that a warm stream of air can be sent from the chest **101**. In some examples, multiple heat exchangers or reversible/dual-function heat exchangers may be used

to perform both the cooling and heating functions.

(28) After pulling/pushing the air into the heat exchanger **218**, the fan **304** can further route and discharge the conditioned air through the outlet port **120** defined in the lid **104**. The outlet port **120** may be defined by other components of the chest **101** or the lid **104** and may be positioned in different positions than shown. In some examples, the outlet port **120** may be located on an upper portion of a side of the chest **101** to direct air laterally outwards at a subject positioned nearby. The outlet port **120** may take a variety of forms depending on where it is desirable to direct the conditioned air. As shown in FIG. **1**, the outlet port **120** may be curved such that the conditioned air is directed across the top of the lid **104**. In some examples, it may be desirable to direct the conditioned air upwards or laterally away from the lid **104**. The diameter and shape of the outlet port **120** will affect the pressure and shape of the airstream that exits the chest. For examples, a smaller outlet port **120** may create higher pressure and discharge air at a higher velocity.

(29) The fan **304** may be a 12-volt direct current fan with a capacity of 226 cubic feet per minute. In some examples, the fan **304** may be adapted from a 105 mm PC case fan, sourced from another fan, or it may be custom fan constructed for use with the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The fan **304** could also be an alternating current fan, depending on the battery and control panel used. The fan **304** can be located at various locations about the lid **104**. In some examples, the fan **304** is located above the heat exchanger **218** and pulls air from within the reservoir **103** across the heat exchanger **218**. In some examples, the fan **304** is located below the heat exchanger **218** and pushes air from within the reservoir **103** across the heat exchanger **218**.

(30) In the example shown in FIG. **3**, the fan **304** and the heat exchanger **218** are retained within the lid **104**. The heat exchanger **218** and the fan **304** may be attached to the lid **104**. For example, the heat exchanger **218** can be attached to the interior of the lid **104** while the fan **304** is positioned within the lid **104**. It may be advantageous for the heat exchanger **218** to be positioned on the interior of the lid **104** such that it is in direct communication with the reservoir **103**. The heat transfer occurring between the heat exchanger **218** and the air passing across the heat exchanger **218** can cause condensation to occur. When the heat exchanger **218** is in direct communication with the reservoir, condensation can drip directly back into the reservoir, and the fluid can be recirculated throughout the system. However, it is understood that, in other examples, it may be advantageous for the fan **304** and the heat exchanger **218** to be located in another portion of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** (e.g., located in the reservoir **103**).

(31) In some examples, the flexible tube **122** can be connected to the outlet port **120** to further direct the discharged stream of air in a direction preferred by the user. The flexible tube **122** can be of any desired length and can be detachable from the outlet port **120**. The user may manipulate the orientation of the flexible tube **122** by hand. In some examples, the orientation of the flexible tube **122** can be controlled electronically or automatically. In some examples, the flexible tube may move back and forth or oscillate between orientations, like a fan, to provide air-conditioned air in a plurality of directions repetitively. The flexible tube **122** can connect to the outlet port **120** in a variety of ways, for example, the flexible tube **122** could snap into place or could slide into the outlet port **120** and be secured under compression from the outlet port **120**.

(32) In some examples, the flexible tube **122** can be connected to an air shaft **312** which may include the vent **124**. Like the outlet port **120**, the flexible tube **122** and the air shaft **312** can connect in a variety of manners, such that the user can easily connect and disconnect the two to switch between functions and configurations. The air shaft **312** may further direct the air in a particular direction certain direction and out the vent **124**. The vent **124** can variably control the amount of air and the angle at which air is discharged. For example, the vent **124** may have rotatable shutters that control the angle and the amount of air that is discharged. In some examples, the flexible tube **122** can expand and retract. For example, when the flexible tube **122** is connected to both the outlet port **120** and the vent **124**, the flexible tube is in a retracted position. When the flexible tube **122** is disconnected from the air shaft **312**, the flexible tube **122** can expand to a

variety of lengths, so the air being pushed through the flexible tube **122** can travel a greater distance before being discharged to a specific location.

(33) The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** is not only able to discharge temperature-controlled and humidity-controlled air but can spray and mist droplets of liquid. This feature expands the functions and capabilities of the system. When combined with the features previously described, the portable multi-function air conditioner is a versatile air conditioning system usable in all environments. In some examples, the cooled liquid drawn up through the liquid conduit **222** can also run through the spray nozzle conduit **226** to be discharged through the spray nozzle **220**. The discharged air can intermingle with the discharged liquid, which further conditions the air. In some examples, a spray pump **318**, such as a high-pressure pump, can move the liquid from the liquid conduit **222** and the spray nozzle conduit **226** out of the spray nozzle **220**. The spray nozzle **220** is configured to spray a mist of liquid. Depending on certain variables within the system, the preferred orifice diameter of the spray nozzle **220** may range for 0.05 mm to 0.35 mm, for example, 0.05 mm, 0.1 mm, 0.15 mm, 0.2 mm, 0.25 mm, 0.3 mm, or 0.35 mm. Changing the orifice diameter of the spray nozzle **220** can affect the spray radius and/or the droplet size of the liquid that is discharged, among other things.

(34) In some examples, the spray pump **318** can be situated in a compartment **319** recessed in the lid **104**. To ensure that the spray pump **318** remains dry and can function in all environments, the compartment **319** can be provided with a compartment cover **321**. A cover seal **323** (e.g., gasket, o-ring, etc.) may be provided to seal the compartment cover **321** over the spray pump **318** within the compartment **319**. The compartment cover **321** can be removable fixed to the lid by screws or other means to allow for replacement of the spray pump **318** or other components within the compartment **319**.

(35) In some examples the spray nozzle conduit **226** runs out the outlet port **120** and through the flexible tube **122** to a distal tip of the flexible tube **122**. In some examples, like the flexible tube **122**, the spray nozzle conduit **226** can expand and retract, with the expansion and retraction of the flexible tube **122** when the flexible tube is disconnected from either the air shaft **312** or the outlet port **120**. In other examples, the spray nozzle conduit **226** exits the chest **101** from a different outlet port than the outlet port **120**. The spray nozzle **220** may be fixed and centered about the circumference of the flexible tube **122**. Centering the spray nozzle **220** about the circumference of the flexible tube **122** may ensure that the sprayed liquid is projected symmetrically and evenly outward when coupled with the stream of air flowing through the flexible tube **122**. In some examples, the spray nozzle **220** may be fixed to a side of the flexible tube **122**. The spray nozzle **220** may extend beyond the distal tip of the flexible tube **122** or may stop short of the end of the distal tip of the flexible tube **122** such that it is hidden from view. When the spray nozzle **220** extends through the flexible tube **122** and/or is fixed to a distal end of the flexible tube **122**, it prevents excess liquid from getting stuck within the flexible tube **122**, thereby minimizing mold, mildew, and other difficulties resulting from stagnant liquid in a confined space.

(36) In some examples, the spray nozzle conduit **226** need not run through the flexible tube **122** and can be positioned separate from the flexible tube **122** such that the air in the flexible tube **122** and the sprayed liquid from the spray nozzle **220** can be routed in different directions.

(37) In some examples, a filter **320** may be included to filter the liquid running through the spray nozzle conduit **226**. The filter **320** may filter the liquid within the spray nozzle conduit **226** before the liquid reaches the spray pump **318**. The filter **320** may include a paper filter cartridge. Other types of filters may be used. In some examples, the filter **320** is located in the compartment **319** next to the spray pump **318**. By filtering the liquid before it reaches the spray pump **318** and before it reaches the spray nozzle **220** can prevent the spray nozzle **220** and/or the spray pump **318** from clogging and can extend their life before they need to be cleaned or replaced. In the example shown, the spray nozzle **220** is removable and replaceable. The spray nozzle **220** may rotatably couple to a fixture (not shown) which connects the spray nozzle conduit **226** to the distal end of the

flexible tube **122**. The removable nature of the spray nozzle **220** allows for the use of a new nozzle if the spray nozzle **220** becomes clogged, dirty, or wears out. In some examples, the spray nozzle **220** rotatably couples directly to the spray nozzle conduit **226**, for example, when the spray nozzle conduit **226** is not fixed to the flexible tube **122**.

(38) In some examples the spray nozzle **220** is adjustable so that the diameter of the spray and/or the size of the liquid droplets varies, depending on the use. In some examples, the spray nozzle **220** does not spray or mist the liquid, but rather, squirts it in a continuous stream. This may be desirable for cooling a subject at a faster rate or for a certain aesthetic affect. In some examples, the stream of liquid from the spray nozzle **220** can resemble the stream from a hose or a squirt gun.

(39) The spraying and misting function of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** can occur simultaneously or separately from the air conditioning function. When occurring together the stream of air discharged from the chest **101** may help to carry and spread the misted liquid further than it normally would. This allows the sprayed liquid to cover a larger area, providing more reliable and constant relief from the dangers of the environment. A directable stream of cool and moist air can be directed in any direction the user desires to relieve the subject from the dangers of hot weather, or to create a more comfortable environment, even if not in present danger. The spraying and air functions need not be performed together, as described further below.

(40) In some examples, the compartment **319** may also house a battery **322** or other power supply. The battery can be located elsewhere (e.g., in the reservoir **103**, attached to the exterior of the lid **104**, etc.) In the example shown in FIG. 3, the battery **322** removably attachable to battery terminal(s) **324** fixed to the compartment cover **321**. The battery **322** may be a rechargeable battery based on nickel-cadmium, nickel-metal hydride, lithium, or other battery technology. The battery **322** may have a charge indicator that indicates a level of charge of the battery **322**. In some examples, when the user presses a button, a level of charge is indicated by the lighting of one or more LEDs. Other forms of charge indicators can be implemented. In some examples, the battery **322** is a 12-volt battery with a capacity of 10,000 mAh. Provisions may also be made for an A/C or DIC adapter (not shown) to recharge the battery **322** and/or power the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The compartment **319** may be configured to accept a number of disposable-type batteries such as a lantern battery, D-cells, or the like.

(41) In some examples, as shown in FIG. 3, a control panel **326** is housed at least partially within the upper shell **300** and/or the lower shell **302**. The control panel **326** allows the user to provide an input and control the functions and settings of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The control panel **326** may include buttons **328** for selecting various settings, which activate and deactivate various components of the system (e.g., the fan **304**, the heat exchanger **218**, the spray pump **318**, the pump **216**, the spray nozzle **220**, etc.). The control panel **326** may be accessible from outside the lid **104**. In some examples, the control panel is accessible when the lid **104** of the chest **101** is opened. The control panel may also be located in the body **102** of the chest. The control panel may be operable remotely or via a corded controller, rather than at the chest **101**, as described in more detail with respect to FIG. 4.

(42) In some examples, the speed of the fan **304** is variable. The speed of the fan **304** may have three or more speed settings, for example, a low speed setting, a medium speed setting, and a high speed setting. Additionally, the fan **304** may be set to blow air for a certain period of time, for example, 1 minute, 5 minutes, 10 minutes, 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 45 minutes, 1 hour, etc.

(43) In some examples, the rate of cooling of the air performed by the heat exchanger **218** is variable. For instance, the button(s) **328** on the control panel **326** can activate an “extreme cool” function to increase the air conditioning capabilities and maximize the difference in temperature of the air discharged from the chest compared to the ambient temperature. When the “extreme cool” setting is activated, the pump **216** may be engaged. When the pump **216** is engaged, the rate at which the heat exchanger circulates cool liquid through the heat exchanger **218** may be increased or maximized, thereby increasing the amount of heat transferred from the air and into the surface

area on the heat exchanger **218**. When “extreme cool” is not needed or not desired, the “extreme cool” setting can be deactivated and the rate at which the pump **216** pulls in cool liquid into the heat exchanger **218** may be lowered or stopped. When the heat exchanger **218** cycles through the cool liquid at a slower rate, the air will not be cooled to the same degree. However, using less or none of the cooled liquid in the chest **101** will lengthen the amount of time that any ice stays frozen or cold objects remain cold. In some examples, the rate of cooling is selectable with a dial or there may be any number of cooling settings. The variability and versatility of these and other aspects of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** allow for function and successful use in all climates and environments.

(44) The control panel can be designed in a water-proof and weather-resistant manner to allow the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** to be safely used outdoors and in all environments. The control panel **326** may be sealed into the upper shell **300** via a control panel seal **332** (e.g., gasket, o-ring, etc.).

(45) In some examples, the control panel **326** is fitted with any number of ports/connectors **330** (e.g., USB ports, DC connectors, coaxial connectors, etc.) to charge mobile or other devices. This charging function increases the versatility of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. Due to the insulative properties of the chest **101**, ice can remain frozen for many days within the reservoir **103**. In some instances, the ice may remain frozen longer than a mobile device can maintain a charge. In situations where the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** is being used for extended periods of time, for example, when camping, or at sporting tournaments, it is advantageous to be able to charge a device while not having to return from the remote location.

(46) In some examples, the pump **216**, the spray pump **318**, the fan **304**, the heat exchanger **218**, and/or other electrical components, may be powered by a power supply. The power supply may be in the lid **104** or elsewhere. It may be necessary to route a power connection **232** (shown in FIG. 2) from the power supply and the control panel **326** to the various components.

(47) Specifically, with respect to the pump **216**, which may be located in the lower portion of the reservoir **103**, the power connection **232** may need to travel a distance to the lower portion of the reservoir **103**. The power connection **232** may be in the form of a power cable. A small power opening **234** (shown in FIG. 2) may be defined by an upper portion of the cover **228** for passing the power connection **232** down from the power supply. In some examples, where the cover **228** is located near a hinge **214**, the hinge may serve as a form as protection for the power connection **232**. Other positions and methods for supplying power to the various components are possible. For example, the power connection **232** could extend within the body **102** to reach the pump **216** in the lower portion of the reservoir **103**. Such a configuration may provide protection for the power connection **232**. With respect to the spray pump **318**, another power connection **232** may run from the power supply and the control panel **326** into the compartment **319** to connect to the spray pump **318**.

(48) FIG. 4 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner **400** usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. As shown, the control panel **326** can be attached to the battery **322**. The power connection **232** may connect the control panel **326** to the pump **216** located in the lower portion of the reservoir **103**. The power connection **232** may also connect the control panel **326** to the spray pump **318**. Additionally, the power connection **232** may connect the control panel **326** to the fan **304**. The reservoir **103** is filled with ice and cool liquid, the cool liquid resulting from melting of the ice. The liquid conduit **222** extends from the pump **216** and splits into two separate conduits, the heat exchanger intake conduit **224** and the spray nozzle conduit **226**. The heat exchanger **218** is filled with cool liquid from the heat exchanger intake conduit **224**. After the cool liquid circulates through the heat exchanger **218**, it may return from the heat exchanger **218** to the reservoir **103** by way of the return conduit **230**. The fan **304** pulls air from the reservoir **103** and pushes the air through the heat exchanger **218**. The fan **304** can be located on either side of the heat exchanger **218**. For example, when the heat exchanger

218 is located between the reservoir **103** and the fan **304**, the fan pulls the air from the reservoir **103** and through the heat exchanger **218**. As the cool air passes across the heat exchanger **218**, the air loses heat to the heat exchanger **218** and becomes even cooler. The cold air may be discharged from the chest **101** through the outlet port **120**. The flexible tube **122** connected to the outlet port **120** routes the cold air in a desired direction. Meanwhile, liquid in the spray nozzle conduit **226** is moved through the filter **320**. The spray pump **318** pushes the liquid forcefully out of the spray nozzle **220**. The cold air exiting the flexible tube **122** coupled with the spray from the spray nozzle **220** creates a consistently cold stream of moist airflow.

(49) The control panel **326**, as described above with respect to FIG. 3, includes one or more buttons for selecting the and controlling the multiple functions of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The control panel **326** can be integrated into the chest **101**. It is understood that the control panel **326** is not limited to buttons. Other types of switches may provide similar control (e.g., rotary knobs, switches, rocker and/or toggle switches, etc.). The control panel **326** may act as a variable switch between the battery **322** and the fan **304** to provide varying amounts of power or current via power connections **232** to the various components. In this regard, the control panel **326** is capable of functioning as a switch between the battery **322** and the various components.

However, the control panel **326** may also function as part of a relay circuit. In some examples, the control panel **326** and/or the battery **322** may provide a level of power or current to the pumps and fan to keep the system operating efficiently and to continuously provide the heat exchanger with chilled or heated liquid. In some examples, the control panel **326** may also selectively control the speed of the pump **216** and the spray pump **318**.

(50) Alternatively, a wired remote **402** can control the multiple functions. Furthermore, in some examples, a wireless remote **404** can control the multiple functions, employing a wireless communication technology. The wired remote **402** and the wireless remote **404** can be used instead of or in addition to the control panel **326**. Remote operation allows a user to control the system without having to be nearby, or without having to fully divert attention away from another task. For example, the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** may be controlled from the driver's seat of a vehicle, from a lawn chair, from a pilot's seat of an aircraft, from the front seat of a golf cart, etc. The wireless remote **404** can provide similar controllability as the wired remote **402** and the control panel **326**, but possible in a more convenient fashion.

(51) The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** described herein may comprise various conduits, hoses, and pathways as known to one skilled in the art for being suitable for transporting cooled and/or heated liquid.

(52) It is appreciated that in operation, a user may fill the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** with ice, cold water, hot water, or hot objects, which will be maintained in its state by the insulating properties of the reservoir **103**. It is contemplated that users may place beverages or other food items within the reservoir **103**. As long as a minimal volume of liquid is allowed to remain in the reservoir **103**, the liquid may be pumped by the pump **216** to the heat exchanger **218** where the fan **304** can utilize the same for changing the temperature of the air. The conditioned air and the mist can then be directed via the outlet port **120**, the flexible tube **122**, the air shaft **312**, and/or the vent **124** to a location desired by the user.

(53) The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** described herein may be wheeled or carried to a desired location and can be activated for providing the cool functions. As the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** utilizes the cooling capacity of the internally stored ice and/or water, the cooling capabilities may fall to an unacceptable level over a period of time. However, a user can add more ice and/or drain some of the existing liquid via the drain **108**. Typical ice-storing coolers need to be drained at the end of their use. However, using the systems and methods described herein, the liquid from within the chest will be discharged in the form of spray or mist. Accordingly, the need to drain the liquid from ice coolers is eliminated or substantially reduced.

(54) Throughout the present disclosure, use of liquids is discussed for use in the air cooling and

spraying functions of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. In some cases, this liquid can be water, or ice water. It is understood that crushed or block ice can be used. In other examples, the ice may be sequestered from the liquids that are allowed to flow. For example, cold packs, ice packs, or even dry ice may be used to chill the liquid which is sent through the heat exchanger **218** and other components for cooling the air. In some examples, other efficient coolants can be used, such as ethylene glycol mixtures. Efficient coolants may be sequestered from water within the reservoir **103**. The efficient coolants can be circulated through the radiator while the water is pumped to the spray nozzle **220**. This allows system to utilize coolants more efficient than water for cooling purposes, while still allowing the chest **101** to function as a ice chest or beverage cooler.

(55) In other instances, the liquid may be scented and/or contain various chemicals such as DEET for repelling insects and other animals. A scented liquid may provide further enjoyment or ambiance. Other scents may be usable to deter animals while camping. Similarly, insect repellant or sunscreen can be sprayed into the air or onto a person. Compared to normal methods for applying insect repellant, the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** allows for convenient and complete coverage. In some examples, where a user wishes to melt ice within the cooler faster than the ambient temperature could, the user can add salt to the reservoir **103** to speed up the process.

(56) FIG. 5 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner **500** usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. The portable multi-function air conditioner **500** may have a similar appearance and design as the portable multi-function air conditioners shown in FIGS. 1-4. However, rather than using the pump **216** to pull liquid from the reservoir **103**, another pump **502** can be employed. Pump **502** may be a dedicated pump for driving water to the spray nozzle **220**. In some examples, the spray pump **318** may or may not be needed. The pump **502** which can be located in the reservoir **103** near the pump **216** may replace the spray pump **318**, which may be located in the lid. Employing two pumps **216** and **502** and having the separate heat exchanger intake conduit **224** for the cooling liquid and the separate spray nozzle conduit **226** for the liquid be sprayed out of the spray nozzle **220** may allow the system to more accurately keep pressures within the conduits **226**, **224** at desirable levels. Furthermore, keeping the liquid separated between the spray nozzle conduit **226** and the heat exchanger intake conduit **224** may be beneficial when using various coolants and when creating a closed system for the cooling liquid when using an additional heat exchanger to re-cool the cooling liquid that has already passed through the heat exchanger, as explained more fully below with respect to FIG. 6.

(57) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of a portable multi-function air conditioner **600** usable in all environments, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. The portable multi-function air conditioner **600** may have a similar appearance and design as the portable multi-function air conditioners shown in FIGS. 1-5. However, rather than exhausting the liquid in the return conduit **230** directly into the reservoir **103**, the liquid can be pushed through a second heat exchanger **602**. The second heat exchanger **602** may be submerged in the reservoir **103** and exposed to the liquid and solids therein (e.g., water, ice, cold packs, etc.). The liquid passed through the second heat exchanger **602** will be re-chilled before being pumped by the pump **216** back into the heat exchanger **218** or returned back into the reservoir **103**. Sequestering the liquids for cooling from the liquids accessible by the user may be beneficial for various reasons. If other coolants are used, the coolants will not contaminate the water and ice in the chest **101**. Even when cooled water is used, sequestering the cooling water from the other items in the chest **101** will prevent any contaminants from the radiator and/or pipes and tubes of the system from blending back with the other items.

(58) FIG. 7 is an illustrative method **700** relating to conditioning air in all environments using a multi-function air conditioner, in accordance with an example of the present disclosure. While FIG. 7 illustrates a method according to one example, other examples may omit, add to, reorder, and/or modify any of the operations shown in FIG. 7. The operations of the illustrative method **700** selectively performing a first conditioning function, a second conditioning function, and/or a third

conditioning function, among other functions of the portable multi-function air conditioners described herein. The third conditioning function can be performed by performing the first conditioning function and the second conditioning function simultaneously. The selection of the first, second, and third functions can be based on the ambient environment surrounding the chest **101**, among other things (e.g., user preferences), explained below.

(59) In some examples, the first conditioning function may be useful in humid environments, where the air is filled with moisture, to remove moisture from the air and to control the temperature of the air. In this situation, the second conditioning function which includes discharging liquid from the spray nozzle, may not be necessary or desirable.

(60) In some examples, the second conditioning function may be useful, for example, in dry environments, where the air lacks humidity and moisture, to spray liquid into the air and increase the humidity of the air. In this situation, the first conditioning function may not be necessary or desirable, if the temperature of the air is comfortable, or the chest **101** is not filled with liquid, or has run out of liquid.

(61) In some examples, the third conditioning function may be useful, for example, in hot/cold and dry environments, where the air lacks humidity and moisture, and where the air is cold or hot, to humidify and control the temperature of the air simultaneously.

(62) Operation **702**, in some examples, includes selectively performing the first, second, and/or third functions includes receiving at least one input of a plurality of inputs at a control panel of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The at least one input may be provided by a user based on conditions of the ambient environment surrounding the multi-function air conditioner.

(63) In some examples, as shown in FIG. **3**, the control panel **326** is housed at least partially within the upper shell **300** and/or the lower shell **302**. The control panel **326** allows the user to control the functions and settings of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100**. The control panel **326** may include the buttons **328** for selecting various settings, which activate and deactivate various components of the system (e.g., the fan **304**, the heat exchanger **218**, the spray pump **318**, the pump **216**, the spray nozzle **220**, etc.). The control panel **326** may be accessible from outside the lid **104**. In some examples, the control panel **326** is accessible when the lid **104** of the chest **101** is opened. The control panel **326** may also be located in the body **102** of the chest. The control panel **326** can be integrated into the chest **101**. It is understood that the control panel **326** is not limited to buttons. Other types of switches may provide similar control (e.g., rotary knobs, switches, rocker and/or toggle switches, etc.). The control panel **326** may act as a variable switch between the battery **322** and the fan **304** to provide varying amounts of power or current via power connections **232** to the various components. In this regard, the control panel **326** is capable of functioning as a switch between the battery **322** and the various components. However, the control panel **326** may also function as part of a relay circuit. In some examples, the control panel **326** and/or the battery **322** may provide a level of power or current to the pumps and fan to keep the system operating efficiently and to continuously provide the heat exchanger with chilled or heated liquid. In some examples, the control panel **326** may also selectively control the speed of the pump **216** and the spray pump **318**.

(64) The control panel **326** may be operable remotely or via a corded controller, rather than at the chest **101**. The wired remote **402** can control the multiple functions. Furthermore, in some examples, the wireless remote **404** can control the multiple functions, employing a wireless communication technology. The wired remote **402** and the wireless remote **404** can be used instead of or in addition to the control panel **326**. Remote operation allows a user to control the system without having to be nearby, or without having to fully divert attention away from another task.

(65) Operation **704**, in some examples, includes moving air across contents held in the reservoir **103**. This operation may be performed using the fan **304**. In some examples, warm air is drawn into the reservoir **103** of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** by the fan **304** through the at least one inlet **118**. The at least one inlet **118** can be located at the conjunction of the lid **104** and the

body **102**. Such a location may allow the at least one inlet **118** to be hidden from plain view and allows air to enter the chest **101** even when a substantial amount of ice, liquid, food, drinks, or other objects are located in the reservoir **103**. As air moves across these cold objects and cold liquid, the temperature of the warm air begins to decrease, before continuing throughout the rest of the system.

(66) In some examples, the at least one inlet **118** may be configured to allow air to enter the chest **101** when suction force is applied by the system (e.g., when a fan is pulling air from within the chest **101**) but prevents air from exiting the chest **101** when the suction force subsides (e.g., when the fan is off). In this sense, the inlet **118** may act as a one-way valve. Inlets **118** of this nature ensure that cold air within the chest **101** does not escape, increasing the time it takes for ice within the chest **101** to melt.

(67) Operation **706**, in some examples, includes moving a first portion of liquid held in the reservoir **103** through the heat exchanger **218**. The pump **216** described above with respect to FIG. 2 can move cool liquid (e.g., water) from the reservoir **103** through the liquid conduit **222**, through the heat exchanger intake conduit **224**, and into and through the heat exchanger **218**. The cool liquid can thereby cool fins of the heat exchanger **218**, the fins allowing for heat transfer to occur between the heat exchanger **218** and air passing across it. After the cool liquid passes through the heat exchanger **218** it may return to the reservoir **103** by way of the return conduit **230**.

(68) Operation **708**, in some examples, includes moving air held in the reservoir **103** across the heat exchanger **218** using the fan **304** to condition the air. In some examples, the **304** is housed between the upper shell **300** and the lower shell **302**. The fan **304** may be positioned in close proximity to the heat exchanger **218**, so that the fan can draw/push air from within the reservoir **103** across the heat exchanger **218**. As air passes across the heat exchanger **218**, the air will lose heat to the fins, due temperature difference between the heat exchanger **218** and the air.

(69) Operation **710**, in some examples, includes discharging the conditioned air through the outlet port **120** in the multi-function air conditioner using the fan **304**. The outlet port **120** may be defined by other components of the chest **101** or the lid **104** and may be positioned in different positions than shown. In some examples, the outlet port **120** may be located on an upper portion of a side of the chest **101** to direct air laterally outwards at a subject positioned nearby. The outlet port **120** may take a variety of forms depending on where it is desirable to direct the conditioned air. As shown in FIG. 1, the outlet port **120** may be curved such that the conditioned air is directed across the top of the lid **104**. In some examples, it may be desirable to direct the conditioned air upwards or laterally away from the lid **104**.

(70) Operation **712**, in some examples, includes discharging a second portion of the liquid through the spray nozzle **220** using at least one pump. For example, the cooled liquid drawn up through the liquid conduit **222** can also run through the spray nozzle conduit **226** to be discharged through the spray nozzle **220**. In some examples, the spray pump **318**, such as a high-pressure pump, can move the liquid from the liquid conduit **222** and the spray nozzle conduit **226** out of the spray nozzle **220**. In some examples, the spray pump **318** can be situated in the compartment **319** recessed in the lid **104**. The spray nozzle **220** is configured to spray a mist of cooled liquid. In some examples the spray nozzle conduit **226** runs out the outlet port **120** and through the flexible tube **122** to a distal tip of the flexible tube **122**. In some examples, like the flexible tube **122**, the spray nozzle conduit **226** can expand and retract, with the expansion and retraction of the flexible tube **122** when the flexible tube is disconnected from either the air shaft **312** or the outlet port **120**. In other examples, the spray nozzle conduit **226** exits the chest **101** from a different outlet port than the outlet port **120**. The spray nozzle **220** may be fixed and centered about the circumference of the flexible tube **122**. Centering the spray nozzle **220** about the circumference of the flexible tube **122** may ensure that the sprayed liquid is projected symmetrically and evenly outward when coupled with the stream of air flowing through the flexible tube **122**. In some examples, the spray nozzle **220** may be fixed to a side of the flexible tube **122**. The spray nozzle **220** may extend beyond the distal tip of

the flexible tube **122** or may stop short of the end of the distal tip of the flexible tube **122** such that it is hidden from view. When the spray nozzle **220** extends through the flexible tube **122** and/or is fixed to a distal end of the flexible tube **122**, it prevents excess liquid from getting stuck within the flexible tube **122**, thereby minimizing mold, mildew, and other difficulties resulting from stagnant liquid in a confined space. In some examples, the spray nozzle conduit **226** need not run through the flexible tube **122** and can be positioned separate from the flexible tube **122** such that the air in the flexible tube **122** and the sprayed liquid from the spray nozzle **220** can be routed in different directions.

(71) In some examples, the speed of the fan **304** is variable. The speed of the fan **304** may have three or more speed settings, for example, a low speed setting, a medium speed setting, and a high speed setting. Additionally, the fan **304** may be set to blow air for a certain period of time, for example, 1 minute, 5 minutes, 10 minutes, 15 minutes, 30 minutes, 45 minutes, 1 hour, etc. In some examples, the rate of cooling of the air performed by the heat exchanger **218** is variable. For instance, the button(s) **328** on the control panel **326** can activate an “extreme cool” setting to increase the air conditioning capabilities and maximize the difference in temperature of the air discharged from the chest compared to the ambient temperature. When the “extreme cool” setting is activated, the pump **216** may be engaged. When the pump **216** is engaged, the rate at which the heat exchanger circulates cool liquid through the heat exchanger **218** may be increased or maximized, thereby increasing the amount of heat transferred from the air and into the surface area on the heat exchanger **218**. When “extreme cool” is not needed or not desired, the “extreme cool” setting can be deactivated and the rate at which the pump **216** pulls in cool liquid into the heat exchanger **218** may be lowered or stopped. When the heat exchanger **218** cycles through the cool liquid at a slower rate, the air will not be cooled to the same degree. However, using less or none of the cooled liquid in the chest **101** will lengthen the amount of time that any ice stays frozen or cold objects remain cold. In some examples, the rate of cooling is selectable with a dial or there may be any number of cooling settings. The variability and versatility of these and other aspects of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** all for function and successful use in all climates and environments.

(72) The portable multi-function air conditioner described herein is not limited to the first, second, and third functions of the method **700**. Various settings, states, and ambient environments give way to other functions according to the systems and methods described herein. Certain combinations of the features of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** result in other functions that may be best suited for particular environments. For example, functions which include heating the air, functions that charge devices, functions that keep contents within the chest **101** insulated, functionalities that emit scents and other chemicals (e.g., bug spray, sunscreen, etc.) into the environment.

(73) Some of the examples described herein discuss using cool liquid within a chest to further cool air that has already been cooled by the presence of ice, cool liquid, or other cold objects within the chest. However, it is understood that, in other examples, hot liquid may be used to heat air that has already been heated by hot liquid or other hot objects within the chest.

(74) The versatility and many functions of the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** makes it capable of use in all environments. The portable multi-function air conditioner **100** is able to remove humidity from the air within the reservoir **103** before discharging the air outwards. Removing the humidity from the air using the heat exchanger **218** is particularly beneficial in humid environments. Discharging cold and dry air towards a person or animal counteracts provides relief from the dangers of hot and humid environments. Other environments, such as hot and dry environments arise, where the portable multi-function air conditioner **100** is able to condition the air (e.g., change temperature) using a variety of methods and further condition the air (e.g., add humidity) as it is being discharged, by use of the spray nozzle **220**. The spray produced by the spray nozzle **220** can also be used separately from the function wherein the temperature of the air is

changed, in situations where the air temperature in the environment is comfortable, but further humidity is desired. These abilities, coupled with the additional functionality and features described herein, allow for use of the portable multi-function air conditioner in all environments.

(75) In the description, specific details have been set forth describing some examples. Numerous specific details are set forth in order to provide a thorough understanding of the examples. It will be apparent, however, to one skilled in the art that some examples may be practiced without some or all of these specific details. The specific examples disclosed herein are meant to be illustrative but not limiting. One skilled in the art may realize other elements that, although not specifically described here, are within the scope and the spirit of this disclosure.

(76) Elements described in detail with reference to one example, example, implementation, or application optionally may be included, whenever practical, in other examples, implementations, or applications in which they are not specifically shown or described. For example, if an element is described in detail with reference to one example and is not described with reference to a second example, the element may nevertheless be claimed as included in the second example. Thus, to avoid unnecessary repetition in the foregoing description, one or more elements shown and described in association with one example, implementation, or application may be incorporated into other examples, implementations, or application unless specifically described otherwise, unless the one or more elements would make an example or implementation non-functional, or unless two or more of the elements provide conflicting functions. Similarly, it should be understood that any particular element, including a system component or a method process, is optional and is not considered to be an essential feature of the present disclosure unless expressly stated otherwise.

(77) Any alterations and further modifications to the described devices, systems, methods, and any further application of the principles of the present disclosure are fully contemplated as would normally occur to one skilled in the art to which the disclosure relates. In particular, it is fully contemplated that the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to one example may be combined with the features, components, and/or steps described with respect to other examples of the present disclosure. In addition, dimensions and temporal relationships provided herein are for providing specific examples and it is contemplated that different sizes, dimensions, relationships and/or ratios may be utilized to implement the concepts of the present disclosure. To avoid needless descriptive repetition, one or more components or actions described in accordance with one illustrative example can be used or omitted as applicable from other illustrative examples. For the sake of brevity, the numerous iterations of these combinations will not be described separately. For simplicity, in some instances the same reference numbers are used throughout the drawings to refer to the same or like parts.

(78) The methods described herein are illustrated as a set of operations or processes. Not all of the illustrated processes may be performed in all examples of the methods. Additionally, one or more processes that are not expressly illustrated or described may be included before, after, in between, or as part of the example processes. In some examples, one or more of the processes may be performed by a controller and/or may be implemented, at least in part, in the form of executable code stored on non-transitory, tangible, computer or machine-readable media that when run by one or more processors may cause the one or more processors to perform one, some, or all of the processes described in relation to the methods herein. Elements illustrated in block diagrams herein may be implemented with hardware, software, firmware, or any combination thereof. One block element being illustrated separate from another block element does not necessarily require that the functions performed by each separate element requires distinct hardware or software but rather they are illustrated separately for the sake of description.

(79) One or more elements in examples of this disclosure may be implemented in software to execute on one or more processors of a computer system such as a controller. When implemented in software, the elements of the examples of the present disclosure are essentially the code segments to perform the necessary tasks. The program or code segments can be stored in a

processor readable storage medium or device that may have been downloaded by way of a computer data signal embodied in a carrier wave over a transmission medium or a communication link. The processor readable storage device may include any medium that can store information including an optical medium, semiconductor medium, and magnetic medium. Processor readable storage device examples include an electronic circuit; a semiconductor device, a semiconductor memory device, a read only memory (ROM), a flash memory, an erasable programmable read only memory (EPROM); a floppy diskette, a CD-ROM, an optical disk, a hard disk, or other storage device. The code segments may be downloaded via computer networks such as the Internet, Intranet, etc. Any of a wide variety of centralized or distributed data processing architectures may be employed. Programmed instructions may be implemented as a number of separate programs or subroutines, or they may be integrated into a number of other aspects of the systems described herein. In one example, the control system supports wireless communication protocols such as Bluetooth, IrDA, HomeRF, IEEE 802.11, DECT, and Wireless Telemetry.

(80) In some instances, well-known methods, procedures, components, and circuits have not been described in detail so as not to unnecessarily obscure aspects of the examples. While certain exemplary examples of the present disclosure have been described and shown in the accompanying drawings, it is to be understood that such examples are merely illustrative of and not restrictive on the broad disclosure herein, and that the examples of the present disclosure should not be limited to the specific constructions and arrangements shown and described, since various other modifications may occur to those ordinarily skilled in the art.

(81) In view of all the teachings herein, the present disclosure contemplates a variety of different aspects including but not limited to the following:

(82) Consistent with some examples, a portable multi-function air conditioner comprises an insulated reservoir configured to hold a liquid and ice, a lid associated with the reservoir to provide selective access to the reservoir, a heat exchanger, at least one pump configured to move a first portion of the liquid through the heat exchanger as a first function and discharge a second portion of the liquid through a spray nozzle as a second function, a fan configured to move air across the heat exchanger, and discharge the air through an outlet port associated with one of the reservoir or the lid, the discharged air intermingling with the discharged second portion of the liquid to condition the air, and a power supply operatively coupled with and providing power to the at least one pump and the fan.

(83) In some examples, the fan is further configured to move the air across the liquid or the ice held in the reservoir. The at least one pump may comprise a first pump and a second pump, the first pump configured to move the first portion of the liquid through the heat exchanger, the second pump configured to discharge the second portion of the liquid through the spray nozzle.

(84) In some examples, the multi-function air conditioner further comprises a control panel operable by a user to engage and disengage the at least one pump and engage and disengage the fan, depending on an ambient environment around the multi-function air conditioner.

(85) In some examples, the multi-function air conditioner further comprising a flexible tube connected to the outlet port, the flexible tube configured to route the air discharged through the outlet port in a desired direction. The second portion of the liquid may move through a spray nozzle conduit before reaching the spray nozzle, and the spray nozzle conduit may pass through the outlet port and at least a portion of the flexible tube connected to the outlet port. The spray nozzle conduit may be connected to a fixture at a distal end of the flexible tube. The spray nozzle may be removably coupled to the spray nozzle conduit through the fixture.

(86) In some examples, the air conditioner is an ice chest. The ice chest may be configured to cool food items. In some examples, the multi-function air conditioner further comprises at least one inlet located near a conjunction of the reservoir and the lid, the at least one inlet configured to pass air from an ambient environment into the multi-function air conditioner. In some examples, the multi-function air conditioner further comprises at least one filter configured to filter the liquid before the

liquid moves through the spray nozzle and/or the heat exchanger.

(87) Consistent with some examples, a method for conditioning air using a portable, multi-function air conditioner having a reservoir and a lid that provides access to the reservoir comprises selectively performing a first conditioning function by moving a first portion of a liquid held in the reservoir through a heat exchanger using at least one pump, moving air across a heat exchanger using a fan, and discharging the conditioned air through an outlet port in the multi-function air conditioner using the fan. The method may further comprise selectively performing a second conditioning function by discharging a second portion of the liquid into the conditioned air from the multi-function air conditioner through a spray nozzle using the at least one pump.

(88) In some examples, the spray nozzle is disposed centrally in an airflow of the conditioned air. In some examples, the method further comprises receiving at least one input of a plurality of inputs at a control panel of the multi-function air conditioner. The at least one input may be provided by a user based on conditions of an ambient environment surrounding the multi-function air conditioner. Performing the first conditioning function may further include moving air across contents of the reservoir.

(89) Consistent with some examples, a multi-function air conditioner having a reservoir for holding a liquid and having a lid providing access to the reservoir is configured to condition air using a first portion of the liquid, discharge the conditioned air through the outlet port as a first function, and discharge a second portion of the liquid through a nozzle into the conditioned air as a second function.

(90) In some examples the system further comprises a first pump operable to flow the first portion of the liquid through a heat exchanger to condition the air, and a second pump operable to flow the second portion of the liquid through the nozzle into the conditioned air. The air conditioner may be an ice chest.

Claims

1. A portable insulated air-conditioning ice chest comprising: an insulated main body configured to hold cold fluid to provide air-conditioning; a lid body configured to provide selective access to the insulated main body, the lid body comprising: a control panel; a fluid pump, the fluid pump in fluid communication with the cold fluid from the insulated main body and controllable by the control panel; a heat exchanger configured to condition air passed therethrough by circulating cold fluid from the insulated main body; and a power connection configured to provide power to the fluid pump in the lid body from a power source.
2. The portable ice chest of claim 1, wherein the fluid pump is configured to move cold fluid from the insulated main body into the lid body via a conduit.
3. The portable ice chest of claim 2, wherein the fluid pump is controllable via the control panel to pump at least some of the cold fluid into the lid body.
4. The portable ice chest of claim 2, wherein the lid body further comprises a filter positioned along the conduit to filter the cold fluid before the cold fluid reaches the fluid pump.
5. The portable ice chest of claim 2, wherein the conduit includes an opening positioned in a lower portion of the insulated main body.
6. The portable ice chest of claim 1, wherein the lid body houses the control panel, the fluid pump, and the heat exchanger.
7. The portable ice chest of claim 1, wherein the fluid pump is recessed in a compartment of the lid body.
8. The portable ice chest of claim 7, wherein the lid body further comprises a compartment cover removably fixed to the compartment.
9. The portable ice chest of claim 8, wherein the compartment cover is sealed to the compartment via a cover seal to prevent ingress of moisture.

10. The portable ice chest of claim 8, wherein the compartment is accessible from above the lid body when the compartment cover is removed.
 11. The portable ice chest of claim 7, further comprising a power supply recessed in the compartment of the lid body.
 12. A method for conditioning air via a portable insulated air-conditioning ice chest, the method comprising: holding cold fluid in an insulated main body; moving, with a fluid pump disposed in a lid body, cold fluid from the insulated main body to the lid body via a conduit associated with the fluid pump; and circulating cold fluid from the insulated main body through a heat exchanger to condition air passed therethrough.
 13. The method of claim 12, further comprising controlling the fluid pump via a control panel on the lid body.
 14. The method of claim 12, further comprising filtering the cold fluid moved from the insulated main body with a filter positioned along the conduit.
 15. The method of claim 12, further comprising recessing the fluid pump in a compartment of the lid body.
 16. The method of claim 15, further comprising removably fixing a compartment cover to the compartment of the lid body.
 17. The method of claim 15, further comprising recessing a power supply in the compartment of the lid body.
 18. The method of claim 12, wherein the conduit includes an opening positioned in a lower portion of the insulated main body.
 19. A portable insulated air-conditioning ice chest comprising: an insulated main body configured to hold cold fluid to provide air-conditioning; a lid body configured to provide selective access to the insulated main body; a control panel carried by the lid body and accessible from outside the ice chest; a fluid pump carried by the lid body, the fluid pump in fluid communication with the cold fluid from the insulated main body and controllable by the control panel; a heat exchanger carried by the lid body and configured to condition air passed therethrough by circulating cold fluid from the insulated main body; and a power connection carried by the lid body and configured to provide power to the fluid pump and a fan in the lid body from a power source.
 20. The portable ice chest of claim 19, comprising the fan carried by the lid body, the fan configured to flow air through the heat exchanger and controllable by the control panel carried by the lid body.
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